

Meoncross School History Department

**YEAR 8 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-
2027)**

Teacher Companion Guide

Curriculum Evaluation & Pedagogical Strengths

Strengths & Commendable Practices

Strong Local History Connections

Integrating local context into national and global events serves as a fantastic pedagogical hook. Mentions of the "Fareham ironmaster" in the Industrialisation unit and the profound impact of the "Lost Generation" on the "village of Stubbington" directly ground the history for our pupils. This makes the narrative tangible and relevant to their lived environment, fostering deeper engagement.

Thematic GCSE Preparation

The inclusion of *Water and Sanitation Through Time* acts as an excellent, low-stakes conceptual primer for the Edexcel GCSE *Medicine Through Time* thematic study. It introduces pupils to broad chronology (Roman to Industrial) and core concepts of change, continuity, and significance long before they hit the rigor of GCSE, ensuring a seamless transition.

Solid Chronological Foundation

By correctly sequencing the curriculum to transition from the broad sweep of *Water and Sanitation* directly into *Medieval England (1066-1485)*, pupils gain the vital contextual bedrock (feudalism, Church power, the monarchy) needed to understand the complex religious and power shifts of the Early Modern era.

De-centering the British Narrative

Starting with, or heavily featuring, the *History of Australia* and framing the Early Modern unit as *Global Encounters (1450-1750)* is a very modern, progressive approach. It intentionally moves away from the traditional, purely anglocentric Tudor/Stuart narrative to look critically at the mechanics of early empire, global trade, and the Transatlantic Slave Trade, creating a more diverse and inclusive curriculum.

Deep Dive on World War I

Splitting the Great War into two distinct units (Causes vs. The War) allows for rigorous historical debate (e.g., the Anglo-German naval race, alliance systems). This ensures

pupils aren't just learning the "mud and blood" narrative, but are actively grappling with complex geopolitical causation.

Points for Improvement for 2026/2027

1. Overweighting the 20th Century

Currently, there are two whole units dedicated to the Great War, plus units mapped out for the Second World War, the Shoah, the Cold War, and Post-War Britain. While vital, this risks creating a "modern-heavy" curriculum, sometimes at the expense of early world history.

2. Pre-1450 Global Diversity

The curriculum would benefit from a deep dive into non-European civilizations before European contact. Exploring the Islamic Golden Age, the Mali Empire, or the Silk Roads *before* looking at European "Global Encounters" in 1450 would give pupils a much more balanced view of global history, rather than encountering diverse cultures primarily through the lens of European colonization.

Evidence of Impact & Curriculum Mapping

1. Local Context & Coastal Connections

As a coastal school, our curriculum is intentionally designed to root global and national historical events in the maritime geography and lived environment of our pupils.

- **Oceanic Voyages & Penal Colonies:** The Year 8 Australia unit is deeply tied to maritime history, the brutality of ocean voyages, and the establishment of coastal settlements like Botany Bay.
- **Maritime Trade & Naval Dominance:** Our Early Modern World unit explicitly links global power to mastery of the oceans, naval exploration, and control of the Transatlantic Slave Trade.
- **The Anglo-German Naval Race:** The Year 8 Great War unit features a dedicated study on HMS *Dreadnought*, proving how a contest for control of the sea directly sparked global conflict.
- **Local Coastal Impact:** We explicitly study the "Fareham ironmaster" and the impact of the "Lost Generation" on the coastal village of Stubbington, bridging global events with local geography.

2. Historical Skills Progression

Our curriculum ensures rigorous, sequential development of disciplinary thinking from Year 7 through to Year 9, preparing pupils for GCSE demands.

- **Source Utility:** Moves from basic comprehension in Year 7 to evaluating provenance, motive, and audience (e.g., analyzing WWI propaganda and recruitment posters) in Year 8.
- **Historical Interpretations:** Progresses from identifying differing views to critically evaluating opposing academic debates (e.g., assessing modern vs. traditional interpretations of the Magna Carta or the 'Lions led by Donkeys' WWI debate) using contextual knowledge.

- **Argumentation (PEEL):** Pupils progress from supported, structured paragraphs to independent, multi-causal essays evaluating 'significance' and 'change over time'.
- **Causation:** Transitions from identifying simple triggers to categorizing long-term vs. short-term causes (e.g., the complex alliance systems and naval race of 1914).

3. Diversity, Equity & Representation

We are committed to delivering a curriculum that de-centers traditional anglocentric narratives, elevating the voices of the marginalized and giving pupils a truly global perspective.

- **Indigenous Perspectives:** The History of Australia unit critically examines the impact of British settlement on Indigenous peoples, moving beyond the traditional 'discovery' narrative.
- **Enslaved Voices:** The Early Modern World unit focuses on the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade and actively highlights how enslaved Africans resisted.
- **The 'Ordinary' Voice:** The Industrialisation unit explores how ordinary working-class people, rather than just monarchs, fought for a voice and the expansion of democracy.
- **The Forgotten Armies:** The Great War unit deliberately questions how much of a 'World' war it was by uncovering the forgotten contributions of the Empire's troops.
- **Experiential Learning (Ypres Trip):** The upcoming Year 9 Battlefields Trip to Ypres provides an invaluable opportunity for pupils to walk the ground of the Great War, cementing their classroom learning with powerful lived experience.

4. Pedagogical Strengths (SEND & Accessibility)

The integrated use of the Meoncross School History Department app alongside printed A4 workbooks and textbooks is deliberately designed to provide maximum support for SEND pupils:

- **Cognitive Offloading:** The combination of guided workbooks directly matched to structured digital tasks significantly reduces working memory strain, allowing pupils to focus entirely on historical thinking.
- **Dual Coding & Scaffolding:** The app utilizes consistent visual layouts, dual-coded images for vocabulary, and highly structured scaffolding (like sentence starters and PEEL frameworks) to support pupils with dyslexia or processing needs.
- **Multimodal Engagement:** By seamlessly transitioning between interactive digital tasks and focused reading from printed textbooks, the curriculum caters to diverse

learning profiles while preventing screen fatigue.

5. Substantive Concept Mapping

In line with modern KS3 history pedagogy, we actively track and weave substantive concepts ("big ideas" like Empire, Religion, and Power) across different periods. Rather than teaching these as isolated definitions, pupils build complex mental schemas by encountering them in varied contexts—from the power of the Medieval Church, through to the ideological clashes of the Cold War.

6. "Worldbuilding" & Cultural Literacy

Before pupils can effectively tackle abstract disciplinary concepts (such as causation or source utility), they require a rich "picture of the past". Our curriculum deliberately immerses pupils in the sensory and lived experiences of historical periods—such as daily life in a medieval village or the harsh realities of a WW1 trench—ensuring a secure cultural and chronological grounding prior to high-level analysis.

KS3: Industrialisation, Empire, and Power (1750–1900)

Year 8 | Industrialisation, Empire, and Power: How did 19th-century Britain transform at home and abroad?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 What powered the Industrial Revolution, and how did a Fareham ironmaster change the world?	• Understand the difference between the domestic system and the factory system. • Explain the significance of Henry Cort's puddling and rolling processes. • Evaluate the importance of location versus innovation in Cort's success.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 2 Was industrial work progress or punishment?	• Understand the working conditions of the early Industrial Revolution with historical nuance. • Evaluate primary sources regarding child labour. • Analyse the 'Optimist vs. Pessimist' historical debate.	• Interrogating Historical Sources • Structured Paragraph

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 Did industrialisation make British towns unlivable?	- Analyse the contrast between imperial wealth and working-class squalor. - Evaluate the usefulness of contrasting primary sources. - Understand the catalysts for public health reform.	- Primary Source Analysis - Exam Practice Writing
Lesson 4 How was the British Empire built and sustained?	- Describe how the British Empire expanded through trade, military conquest, and colonisation across Asia and Africa - Explain how religious missions, economic exploitation, and resistance shaped the experience of empire for colonised peoples - Evaluate the significance of the British Empire in transforming global trade networks	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Synthesis Assessment (8 Marks): 'The British Empire was built and sustained by technological progress rather than violence and exploitation.' To wh... - Working with Contemporary Accounts - Analytical Essay

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 5 How did the Empire strike back? The 1857 Indian Rebellion	- Describe the causes and events of the Indian Rebellion of 1857 and the forms of resistance used by Indian soldiers - Explain how the rebellion challenged British imperial power and led to direct Crown rule over India - Evaluate the significance of the Indian Rebellion as an example of colonial resistance to empire	Evaluating Primary Evidence
Lesson 6 How did ordinary people fight for a voice?	- Describe the key protest movements of the 19th century, including Chartism and trade unionism - Explain how industrialisation created new forms of resistance and demands for democracy and parliamentary reform - Evaluate the significance of working-class protest in expanding the power of Parliament and moving towards democracy	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Synthesis Assessment (8 Marks): 'The violent machine-breaking of the Swing Riots posed a far greater threat to the British establishment than the p... - Interrogating Historical Sources - Structured Paragraph

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 7 How did the road to democracy expand?	- Describe the key reforms that expanded democracy in 19th-century Britain, including the Reform Acts - Explain how protest, resistance, and propaganda drove the gradual extension of the right to vote - Evaluate the significance of the suffrage movement in transforming British democracy by 1900	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Synthesis Assessment: To what extent was Britain a fully functioning democracy by the end of 1884? Use evidence from across the lesson to support y... - Primary Source Analysis - Exam Practice Writing
Lesson 8 Who truly benefited from 19th-century transformation?	- Synthesise knowledge of industrialisation, empire, trade, democracy, and resistance across the 19th century - Construct a sustained argument evaluating who truly benefited from Britains transformation - Deploy specific evidence about power, colonialism, and urbanisation to support a historical judgement	- PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Capstone Essay (16 Marks): 'The transformation of 19th-century Britain was a triumph of progress that benefited the entire nation.' To what extent ... - Analytical Essay

KS3: History of Australia

Year 8 | Invasion, Settlement, or Survival? How should we remember the colonization of Australia?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 Claiming Australia	• Describe how and why the British Empire claimed Australia, including Captain Cook's voyage and the concept of terra nullius • Explain the significance of colonisation for both the British Empire and the Indigenous Australian peoples • Evaluate whether the British arrival should be understood as discovery, settlement, or invasion	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 2 Creating a Convict Colony	• Describe the key features of the convict transportation system and explain why Britain used Australia as a penal colony • Explain how the British Empire used convict labour to establish a colonial foothold in the Pacific • Evaluate the human cost of the convict system and its role in the revolution of Australian settlement	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 Encounters with the Indigenous Peoples	• Describe the impact of British colonisation on Indigenous Australian communities, including the destruction of trade, culture, and land • Explain how Indigenous Australians showed resistance to British settlement through both armed conflict and cultural survival • Evaluate the significance of these encounters for understanding the long-term consequences of empire	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 4 From Penal Colony to Settlement	- Describe how Australia transitioned from a penal colony to a free settlement through migration and the Gold Rush - Explain how empire, revolution, and change shaped the development of Australian society in the 19th century - Evaluate who benefited most from Australia's transformation and who was marginalised	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 5 Lesson 5: Assessment - What's the story of Australia?	- Synthesise knowledge of colonisation, empire, resistance, and change across the history of Australia - Construct a sustained argument evaluating whose perspective should shape how we remember Australia's history - Deploy specific evidence to support a judgement about the legacy of empire in Australia	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Write a narrative account analyzing the development of Australia between the years 1788 and 1855. - Evaluating Primary Evidence

Key Vocabulary: Alsace-Lorraine, Ems Telegram, Reparations, Siege, Imperialism, Scramble for Africa, Empire, Colony, Dreadnought, Arms Race, Two-Power Standard, Naval Supremacy, Triple Entente, Triple Alliance, Reinsurance Treaty, Encirclement, Assassination, Black Hand, Ultimatum, Mobilisation

KS3: Causes of the Great War

Year 8 | How did decades of imperial rivalry and fear culminate in thirty days of madness?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 How was the German Empire created in 1871?	- Describe how Otto von Bismarck used military force and political manipulation to unify Germany into a powerful empire by 1871 - Explain how the creation of the German Empire shifted the balance of power in Europe and created tension with existing empires - Evaluate the significance of German unification as a long-term cause of the First World War	- PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Explain why Bismarck's policy of 'Blood and Iron' was successful in uniting Germany. - Extended Writing (PEEL)
Lesson 2 How did the Franco-Prussian War create a lasting legacy of hatred?	- Identify the penalties forced upon France in 1871. - Explain how the Ems Telegram sparked the Franco-Prussian War. - Evaluate the long-term impact on European relations.	- PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Explain why the Franco-Prussian War created a lasting legacy of hatred between France and Germany. - Structured Paragraph

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 To what extent did the 'Scramble for Africa' increase tension in Europe?	- Identify the main European colonial powers and their territories. - Explain how Kaiser Wilhelm II's 'Place in the Sun' policy threatened Britain. - Evaluate the impact of the Moroccan Crises on the Entente Cordiale.	PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Explain how the 'Scramble for Africa' increased tension between European powers.
Lesson 4 Why did a battleship building contest destroy Anglo-German relations?	- Identify the significance of the HMS Dreadnought. - Explain the concept of the Two-Power Standard and Risk Theory. - Analyze how naval competition fed mutual suspicion.	- PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Explain why the naval race between Britain and Germany damaged their relations. - Analytical Essay
Lesson 5 Did the Alliance System protect Europe or guarantee a global war?	- Identify the members of the Triple Alliance and the Triple Entente. - Explain why countries felt the need to form secret defensive treaties. - Evaluate how the alliance system could drag all of Europe into a regional conflict.	- PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Extended Writing - PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Explain how the Alliance System contributed to the outbreak of the First World War.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 6 Why did a single assassination in Sarajevo ignite a World War?	- Identify the events of 28 June 1914. - Explain how the assassination triggered the alliance system. - Analyze whether the resulting war was inevitable or accidental.	- PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Explain why the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand led to the outbreak of the First World War. - Structured Paragraph
Lesson 7 End of Unit Assessment: The Historians' Debate	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Key Vocabulary: Alsace-Lorraine, Ems Telegram, Reparations, Siege, Imperialism, Scramble for Africa, Empire, Colony, Dreadnought, Arms Race, Two-Power Standard, Naval Supremacy, Triple Entente, Triple Alliance, Reinsurance Treaty, Encirclement, Assassination, Black Hand, Ultimatum, Mobilisation

KS3: The Great War (1914–1919)

Year 8 | How did a single spark in Sarajevo ignite a global conflict that transformed the modern world?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 Why were young men so desperate to join the slaughter of 1914?	- Describe how propaganda, imperial loyalty, and alliance obligations drove mass enlistment across the British Empire - Explain why trench warfare on the Western Front created a devastating stalemate - Evaluate the extent to which soldiers' expectations of war matched the reality of industrial-scale conflict	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Explain why so many young British men eagerly volunteered for the army in 1914. - Evaluating Primary Evidence - Extended Writing (PEEL)
Lesson 2 Did British generals make the horror of trench warfare worse?	- Describe the key features of trench warfare and explain why it caused such devastating casualties - Explain the debate around British military leadership: were generals incompetent or facing impossible circumstances? - Evaluate the significance of propaganda in shaping public perception of the war effort	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Explain why the conditions in the trenches were so difficult for soldiers. - Interrogating Historical Sources - Structured Paragraph

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 How much of a 'World' War was it, and why were the Empire's troops forgotten?	- Describe the contribution of soldiers from across the British Empire, including troops from India, Africa, and the Caribbean - Explain why the contributions of imperial and colonial troops were marginalised in traditional British narratives of the war - Evaluate the significance of protest and resistance movements that emerged from colonial soldiers' wartime experiences	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Explain why the contribution of Empire troops was so important to the British war effort. - Primary Source Analysis - Exam Practice Writing

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 4 How did a war fought miles away completely control daily life in Britain?	- Describe the key features of the Home Front, including rationing, propaganda, and the role of women in industry - Explain how the war expanded the power of Parliament and challenged traditional ideas about democracy and gender - Evaluate the significance of the war as a catalyst for social and political change in Britain	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Explain how the Defence of the Realm Act (DORA) changed everyday life in Britain. - Working with Contemporary Accounts
Lesson 5 Did the Treaty of Versailles solve the problems of 1914, or create the nightmares of 1939?	- Describe the key terms of the Treaty of Versailles and the competing aims of the Allied powers - Explain why the treaty created new tensions through trade restrictions, territorial changes, and the War Guilt Clause - Evaluate whether the Treaty of Versailles represented genuine change or simply planted the seeds for future conflict	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Explain why the Treaty of Versailles caused so much resentment in Germany. - Evaluating Primary Evidence - Extended Writing (PEEL)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 6 How did the "Lost Generation" impact the village of Stubbington?	• Describe the local impact of the Great War on communities like Stubbington, using evidence from war memorials and Church records • Explain the significance of the concept of the 'Lost Generation' for understanding the war's long-term social consequences • Evaluate primary sources (war memorials, photographs, local records) to construct a historically grounded account of local impact	• PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Explain the impact of the First World War on local communities like Stubbington. • Interrogating Historical Sources

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 7 Assessment: The Great War	• Synthesise knowledge of trench warfare, the Home Front, imperial contributions, propaganda, and the Treaty of Versailles • Construct a sustained argument using specific evidence about the causes, course, and consequences of the Great War • Evaluate historical interpretations of the war, including the 'Lions led by Donkeys' debate	• Historical Interpretations: Historical Interpretations: General Haig